



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

Banking, Payments & Personal Finance

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 10

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to talk about bank accounts and cards, understand common fees and transactions, make basic payment requests, and explain a simple banking problem.

Study the money and banking vocabulary, then practise questions about amounts, fees, and transactions. Finish with role-plays involving a bank account, a card payment, and a suspicious charge.

Communication goal

Money conversations become easier when you name the exact transaction, amount, date, and problem. Avoid vague phrases such as “something is wrong with my card.”

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A simple sequence: learn the key language, practise the structure, and then use it in a realistic conversation.

01

LEARN

Vocabulary + useful chunks

02

BUILD

Grammar + model dialogue

03

SPEAK

Writing + role-play

Warm-up

1. Do you usually pay by cash, debit card, credit card, or phone?
2. What banking tasks do you do most often online?
3. Which bank fees do you know in English?
4. Have you ever had a card payment declined?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English using short sentences. Do not worry about mistakes yet. The goal is to activate the topic before studying the new language.



VOCABULARY 01

Essential vocabulary

Study the meaning and then read each example aloud. Try to connect each word to a real situation from your own life.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
bank account	conta bancária	I opened a new bank account.
checking account	conta corrente	My salary goes into my checking account.
savings account	conta poupança	I transfer money to my savings account every month.
balance	saldo	What is my current balance?
deposit	depósito	The deposit should arrive today.
withdrawal	saque	There is a cash withdrawal on my statement.
transfer	transferência	I made a bank transfer yesterday.
transaction	transação	I do not recognize this transaction.
statement	extrato	Check your monthly statement.
fee	taxa	The bank charged a service fee.
interest	juros	The account pays monthly interest.
debit card	cartão de débito	I paid with my debit card.
credit card	cartão de crédito	The credit card bill is due next week.
PIN	senha numérica	Do not share your PIN.
ATM	caixa eletrônico	There is an ATM inside the bank.
exchange rate	taxa de câmbio	What exchange rate are you using?



VOCABULARY 02

Useful transaction language

These expressions help you discuss everyday money movements and card problems clearly.

EXPRESSION	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USE
pay a bill	pagar uma conta	I need to pay the electricity bill.
make a transfer	fazer uma transferência	Can I make an international transfer?
withdraw cash	sacar dinheiro	I need to withdraw some cash.
deposit money	depositar dinheiro	I deposited the money this morning.
card declined	cartão recusado	My card was declined at the store.
pending transaction	transação pendente	This payment is still pending.
service charge	taxa de serviço	Is there a service charge?
monthly fee	tarifa mensal	This account has no monthly fee.
available balance	saldo disponível	My available balance is lower than expected.
due date	data de vencimento	The due date is Friday.
automatic payment	pagamento automático	I set up automatic payment.
unauthorized charge	cobrança não autorizada	I found an unauthorized charge on my card.

Study tip

Learn complete expressions, not only isolated words. In conversation, retrieving a ready-made chunk is much faster than building every sentence from zero.



USEFUL PHRASES

What to say in real situations

These phrases are designed to be spoken. Read them aloud and imagine the exact situation where you would use each one.

SITUATION	PHRASE	USE / MEANING
Account	I would like to open an account.	Open an account.
	What documents do I need?	Ask requirements.
	Is there a monthly fee?	Check account costs.
Payments	Can I pay by card?	Ask payment method.
	Could I split the payment?	Ask about installments / split payment.
	When is the payment due?	Check due date.
Transfers	How long does the transfer take?	Ask processing time.
	Is there a transfer fee?	Check cost.
	What exchange rate will I get?	Ask FX rate.
Problems	My card was declined.	Report a decline.
	I do not recognize this charge.	Report suspicious transaction.
	Could you block the card, please?	Request card block.

Make it yours

Choose three phrases from this page and rewrite them with details from your own life. Personal examples are easier to remember and use naturally.



GRAMMAR FOCUS

How much / how many + money questions

Use “how much” for money, fees, interest, and other uncountable amounts. Use “how many” for countable items such as payments, transfers, or installments.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
How much	How much is the monthly fee?	amount / price
How much	How much money can I withdraw?	uncountable amount
How many	How many transfers are free each month?	countable number
Is there...?	Is there a transfer fee?	ask if a fee exists
Does it cost...?	Does it cost extra to use this card abroad?	ask about cost

Money problem formula

TRANSACTION + AMOUNT + DATE + PROBLEM. Example: “I have a \$42 card transaction from Monday that I do not recognize.”

Mini practice

Complete: How _____ is the monthly fee?

Complete: How _____ free transfers do I get?

Write a question asking about an international transfer fee.

Write a sentence reporting a card charge you do not recognize.

MODEL DIALOGUE

Reporting an unfamiliar card charge

The customer gives the amount and date immediately, making it easier for support to identify the transaction.

CUSTOMER Hi. I need help with a card transaction I do not recognize.

AGENT Of course. What is the amount and date of the transaction?

CUSTOMER It is \$68.40, and it appeared on my statement yesterday.

AGENT Do you recognize the merchant name?

CUSTOMER No. I have never bought anything from that company.

AGENT Okay. Is the card still in your possession?

CUSTOMER Yes, I have it with me.

AGENT I recommend blocking the card while we investigate the charge.

CUSTOMER Can you block it now?

AGENT Yes. I will block it and order a replacement card.

CUSTOMER Will I need to dispute the transaction separately?

AGENT I can start the dispute for you now. You will receive an update in the app.

Be precise with financial support

State the amount, date, transaction type, and what you expected. Precision usually shortens the conversation.

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build useful sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson. More than one answer may be correct.

1. Eu gostaria de abrir uma conta bancária.
2. Existe uma tarifa mensal?
3. Qual é o meu saldo disponível?
4. Eu preciso fazer uma transferência internacional.
5. Quanto tempo a transferência leva?
6. Existe uma taxa de transferência?
7. Qual taxa de câmbio vocês estão usando?
8. Meu cartão foi recusado.
9. Eu não reconheço esta cobrança.
10. Esta transação ainda está pendente.
11. Você pode bloquear o cartão, por favor?
12. Quando é a data de vencimento?

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write a clear banking support message

A support message should identify the account or card issue without including sensitive information such as a full card number or PIN.

Task: Write 90-120 words to bank support about a transaction problem. Explain the transaction type, approximate amount, date, what you expected, what actually happened, and the action you want the bank to take.

Try to include some of these:

- I need help with...
- The transaction was...
- The amount was...
- It appeared on...
- I expected...
- However,...
- Could you check...?
- Please let me know...

Simple structure

ISSUE -> TRANSACTION DETAILS -> EXPECTED RESULT -> REQUEST. Do not include passwords, PINs, or full card details.

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I identify the exact transaction?
- ☐ Did I include the amount and date?
- ☐ Did I explain what is wrong?
- ☐ Did I clearly ask what I want the bank to do?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and complete each situation before asking the AI to correct you. Try to stay in English even when you need time to think.

Role-play 1 · Open an account

The AI is a bank employee. Ask about documents, monthly fees, ATM access, transfers, debit card delivery, and online banking.

Role-play 2 · International transfer

You need to send money abroad. Ask about fees, exchange rate, transfer time, receiving bank information, and total cost.

Role-play 3 · Card problem

Your card was declined and you also see an unfamiliar charge. Explain both issues and decide whether to block the card.

Questions to practise

- Is there a monthly fee?
- How much can I withdraw?
- How long does the transfer take?
- Is there a transfer fee?
- What exchange rate will I get?
- Why was my card declined?
- Is this transaction still pending?
- Can you block my card?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. The goal is to see what you can produce from memory, not only what you recognize on the page.

1. Translate: saldo = _____
2. Translate: extrato = _____
3. Translate: saque = _____
4. Complete: How _____ is the fee?
5. Complete: How _____ free transfers are included?
6. Translate: “Esta transação está pendente.”
7. Translate: “Meu cartão foi recusado.”
8. Ask about the exchange rate.
9. Ask how long a transfer takes.
10. Report an unauthorized charge.
11. Ask the bank to block your card.
12. Ask when the bill is due.
13. Name two types of bank accounts.
14. What four details should you give when reporting a transaction problem?
15. Write one sentence with “available balance”.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The versions below are natural examples using the language taught in this lesson.

Grammar mini practice

- much
- many
- Example: Is there a fee for international transfers?
- Example: I do not recognize a \$25 card charge from yesterday.

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. I would like to open a bank account.
2. Is there a monthly fee?
3. What is my available balance?
4. I need to make an international transfer.
5. How long does the transfer take?
6. Is there a transfer fee?
7. What exchange rate are you using?
8. My card was declined.
9. I do not recognize this charge.
10. This transaction is still pending.
11. Could you block the card, please?
12. When is the due date?

Review strategy

Mark the sentences that felt slow or uncertain. Say those sentences aloud three times, then create one new example with the same structure.

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real objective is to understand the topic and communicate without stopping every time you need a new sentence.

1. balance
2. statement
3. withdrawal
4. much
5. many
6. This transaction is pending.
7. My card was declined.
8. What exchange rate will I get?
9. How long does the transfer take?
10. I do not recognize this charge.
11. Could you block my card, please?
12. When is the due date?
13. checking account / savings account
14. transaction, amount, date, problem
15. Answers vary.

READY FOR CONVERSATION?

If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.

- ✓ Discuss basic accounts, cards, and transactions.
- ✓ Ask about fees, amounts, and exchange rates.
- ✓ Explain a declined or suspicious card transaction.
- ✓ Write a precise support request without sharing sensitive details.

Next lesson suggestion: Fitness, Gym & Healthy Routines